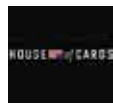




## Women in Wikipedia

Wikipedia has far less pages on women scientists compared to men. But when one tried to even the odds this is what happened. <http://dgit.in/WomenWiki>



## House of Cards

House of Cards makes a case for Big Data in the entertainment industry. <http://dgit.in/CardData>

Industry Connect



# Enhancing your next travel experience

Mohnish Shah, Chairman and Managing Director of TravelLibro tells us how his company is building a social network for travellers who want the best out of their vacations.



◀ Mohnish Shah,  
Chairman and MD, TravelLibro

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### **What is TravelLibro all about?**

**Shah:** It's a first of its kind travel social network and it caters to two popular industries, social networking and the travel industry. It's a space which doesn't exist in a cohesive environment so it's more of a travel experience of a traveller. Right from you wanting to go to a destination until cherishing a suitcase full of memories, everything is catered here. Currently, if you want to plan a holiday, you go to a particular service provider. You might want to check in and create a photo album about your travel but there isn't a single place to record your past, present and future in one single place. So, TravelLibro has information about several cities around the world, which you can use to plan your travel.

### **Are you dependent on user-generated data or are you working on the curation part as well?**

**Shah:** One of our features that we have is the pre-planner. You might have created an itinerary from the past or during the journey. And since every traveller is different, we have given both options. I can get the information that my friend has visited the place and what has he done over there. Along with that, there is a lot

of information that TravelLibro has compiled with a lot of effort put into getting this information. Our team has people who have worked with travel agencies, people who are travellers themselves and also, content editors who compile all the information they are given. We interact with bloggers around the world as well, curating a lot of information from the web. In terms of information, we look at the top things one should keep in mind while visiting locations. Some people might like museums or beaches or just luxury restaurants. What we do is that we pick the best and avoid crowding the users with a lot of information, to suit any type of traveller. We talk to a lot of people and put a lot of heart into the cities that we have covered. We've been doing this information gathering for the last two and a half years and reached 1,200 cities. So before anything else, we made sure our content was rich, even before investing too much into other features. In March 2014, we came out with our Beta site. At that point it was all about itineraries, information that you could use during travel and then TravelLibro evolved. Content was always at the heart of it, because everything else can be achieved in terms of technology and features. Content for a travel portal is something you accumulate over a period of time otherwise it's not going to help your travel or

enhance your experience. That reminds me, while you're on the go in Barcelona, there will be an information tab as well. So, it's picked up by your check-in and location services. You click on that button and it will tell you all the things to do in Barcelona – recommended restaurants and hotels.

### **Is TravelLibro learning from user data? Would it be easy for users in the future to come across better itineraries?**

**Shah:** There has to be a way forward. We intend to evolve to a phase where we help you plan your travel in detail by taking as little information from the user. If we know that you love vegetarian food, travel only in business class, love to travel to Europe etc, the next time you come over to TravelLibro to book or plan your travel, we'll show you things only according to your liking. Say, you're a vegetarian and you love Italian food, and TravelLibro already knows this based on the information entered. When you're at Barcelona, it will pick up your location and give you recommendations for nearby Italian and vegetarian restaurants. So, those are some of the things that we are going to evolve into later. It's all about a traveller's experience, and we are the search engine for travel. As we get more funding, a better team and a bigger team, I'm sure we are definitely going to get there. **d**